Professional Engineering Practice: Ethics, Evidence and Technical Reporting

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About this resource

This original NI4E editorial resource supports professional learning and discussion. It is not represented as a peer-reviewed journal paper, formal engineering standard, or substitute for project-specific professional advice.

Public safety first

Engineering decisions can affect people, property and the environment. Practitioners should work within their competence, raise concerns where safety is at risk and avoid presenting assumptions as verified facts.

Keeping a traceable record

A useful technical record states the question being addressed, the evidence available, the method used, assumptions, limitations, results and recommended action. Drawings, calculations, test results and revision histories should be controlled so that others can review the basis for a decision.

Communicating risk

Reports should distinguish observed conditions from interpretation, explain uncertainty in plain language and identify actions that need an owner or deadline. Concise writing is most effective when it is specific, measurable and supported by evidence.

Continuing professional development

Engineers can maintain competence through structured learning, peer review, practical reflection, mentoring and sharing lessons from completed work. Ethical practice includes acknowledging sources and giving appropriate credit to others.

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